

Week 11 Lit Example Worksheet

TESTING SHAKESPEARE'S COMPARISONS

Purpose: Apply Week 11's method to Brutus and Macbeth. Decide what the comparisons prove and where they overextend.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not retell the plot; test the comparison as proof.

Part 1: Brutus's Source and Target

Question 1.1

In Brutus's serpent's egg comparison, what is the source case and what is the target case?

ANSWER LABEL: Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

What conclusion does Brutus want this comparison to support?

ANSWER LABEL: Part 1 Q2

Part 2: Relevant Similarity and Disanalogy

Question 2.1

What relevant similarity makes Brutus's comparison persuasive?

ANSWER LABEL: Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

What important disanalogy limits Brutus's comparison?

ANSWER LABEL: Part 2 Q2

Part 3: Does Brutus Prove Too Much?

Question 3.1

Does the serpent's egg analogy prove that Caesar must be killed, support only a narrower warning, or merely decorate Brutus's fear? Explain.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

Rewrite Brutus's conclusion so it matches what the analogy can honestly support, unless additional evidence is supplied.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 3 Q2

Part 4: Macbeth's Bear-Like Comparison

Question 4.1

In Macbeth's bear-like comparison, identify the source case, target case, relevant similarity, and one disanalogy.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

Does Macbeth's comparison prove that he has no moral choice left, or does it mainly describe his sense of being trapped? Explain.

ANSWER LABEL: Part 4 Q2